

Solutions and value for the English department

AI-assisted essay marking for GCSE and IGCSE English, designed to reduce repetitive marking workload, surface where students need targeted support, and give leadership clearer visibility of progress across cohorts.

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The English Hub helps English departments reduce the volume of repetitive marking, identify students who may need support earlier, and give leadership a clearer view of how cohorts are progressing across English Language, Literature and EAL.

FOUR PROBLEMS WE ADDRESS

What we hear from English departments

MARKING TURNAROUND

Departments running fortnightly practice essays for a Year-11 cohort are typically 7–14 days behind on marking. By the time feedback lands, the student has moved on.

FEEDBACK DENSITY

Practice-essay feedback is, by necessity, light. No teacher has 90 minutes per essay to give the paragraph-level analysis that actually moves a student from a Grade 6 to a Grade 8.

EAL FAIRNESS

L1-Arabic students writing in English produce different mistakes from L1-English students. Conventional marking can penalise structural transfer errors as basic mistakes when the underlying thinking is sound.

AI WITHOUT DATA-PROTECTION HOMEWORK

Many AI education tools have not done the UK GDPR or PDPPL work. A procurement-aware school asking "where does our students' data live, who trains on it, what's our cross-border consent position?" gets a vague answer from most vendors.

WHAT THE PLATFORM DOES

Five capabilities, end to end

1. AI essay marking against the actual mark scheme

A student submits a practice essay. Within about a minute they receive a suggested band against the assessment objectives the mark scheme uses, paragraph-level feedback referencing those AOs by name, and concrete revision suggestions. **Teachers remain the final authority** on any grade that goes on a report — the AI feedback is formative practice feedback, never an awarded grade.

2. All six exam boards covered, end to end

AQA, Pearson Edexcel, OCR, Eduqas, WJEC, and Cambridge IGCSE. Set texts, language papers, mock exam library, mark schemes, and sample answers. KS3 coverage via Pearson iLowerSecondary English; A-level on roadmap.

3. EAL track with Gulf-Arabic L1 awareness

A2 and B1 native bands are live; B2 and C1 content is in authoring with non-A2 routes currently noindexed pending genuine level-differentiated material. Structural-transfer errors are handled fairly rather than penalised as basic mistakes.

4. Visibility for teachers, leadership, and parents

A teacher dashboard surfaces class-level adoption, weak-area heatmaps by AO, and mock-exam analytics. A leadership view shows department-wide progress, marking-turnaround trend, and cohort-on-cohort benchmarking. Consent-gated weekly parent emails summarise modules completed, time on platform, weak areas, and working-at grade — without sharing the text of a child's essays.

5. ICO Children's Code by default

Every under-18 account ships with high-privacy defaults enforced in code: personalised recommendations off, streak gamification off, behavioural nudges off, non-essential analytics off, marketing off, public leaderboards off, geolocation off. The defaults are asserted by a strict test suite covering ages 11 through 17.

WHERE WE MOVE THE NEEDLE

The levers we move — honestly framed

A NOTE ON OUTCOME CLAIMS

We do not claim a specific grade-improvement statistic. The platform is at launch stage and a validated outcome study has not yet been completed. What we do is move the four levers educational research consistently identifies as drivers of improvement in writing performance.

Lever 1 — Practice volume

The single biggest distinguishing feature of a Grade 9 candidate is the number of essays they wrote, marked, and revised before the exam. The platform makes that volume affordable: a Year 11 student can submit five essays in a week and receive specific feedback on all five.

Lever 2 – Feedback turnaround

Feedback that lands while the work is still mentally fresh is materially more useful than feedback that lands a fortnight later. The platform delivers AO-referenced feedback in about a minute.

Lever 3 – Criteria-referenced feedback

Generic feedback does not move a Grade 6 to a Grade 8. Feedback that names the assessment objective the student missed, gives a specific example of how they missed it, and shows what to do instead — that does. Every feedback line maps directly to the mark scheme the student is sitting.

Lever 4 – Mock exam practice under exam conditions

Timed practice papers under exam conditions are one of the most reliable predictors of exam performance. The mock exam library covers every paper of every board.

ILLUSTRATIVE VALUE

What a department of 80 KS4 students looks like

The figures below are illustrative defaults. They show the working so a finance team can substitute their own numbers. A full ROI document with every assumption laid out is in the companion document, *Illustrative ROI — the working in full*.

160

Practice essays per month
for a Year-11 cohort of 80
students writing fortnightly

~53 hrs

Teacher marking time at 20
minutes per practice essay
(light touch)

< 1 min

Median marking turnaround
on the platform — versus 7–
14 days in the current process

All figures illustrative. Real value depends on department size, current marking practice, and adoption depth. See the companion ROI document.

Procurement-ready data protection

- **PDPPL Article 17 cross-border consent** is live in the signup flow as of 20 May 2026. Qatar-resident users see a named-destination consent panel before account creation.
- **Three v1.0 Data Protection Impact Assessments** on file — parent DPIA for processing children's data, AI features, and analytics.
- **Article 16 permit application dossier** drafted and shelf-ready for NCGAA submission. Held pending Qatari legal sign-off.
- **Separately-appointed Data Protection Officer and Designated Safeguarding Lead.**
- **EU-region primary database** (Supabase Frankfurt). Backend API on Microsoft Azure UK South. AI inference via Anthropic Claude API under DPA prohibiting training on submissions, with contractual zero retention.
- **ICO Children's Code high-privacy defaults** enforced in code for every under-18 account; asserted by strict test coverage.
- **30-calendar-day rights response**, per NCGAA Individuals' Rights Guideline PDPPL-02050219E. **72-hour breach notification** standing readiness.

A full Personal Data Management System (PDMS) index plus RoPA, DPIAs, and sub-processor list are available to school DPOs on written request to dpo@theenglishhub.app.

Talk to us

The simplest next step is a 30-minute conversation. Three ways to start:

- Email dpo@theenglishhub.app with subject "Pilot interest — [your school name]"
- Visit theenglishhub.app/for-schools and book a school pilot
- Contact our Designated Safeguarding Lead, Lauren Johnson, on +974 5187 9582 (24-hour SLA)

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